JUDITH ANDRADE

SERVICE DESIGN | UX RESEARCH | STRATEGIC OPERATIONS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Research-led service designer and operations strategist with six years of experience turning ambiguous service problems into usable digital experiences, practical workflows, and evidence-based decisions. Sole in-house researcher and service designer in a 33,000+ resident municipality, spanning website modernization, 311 problem reporting, facility requests, regulatory design, fee reform, and grant strategy. Earlier product research includes 90+ user interviews, usability studies, and a listing-flow redesign that lifted task success from 33% to 46%.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Service design • UX research • Digital transformation • Information architecture • Workflow improvement • Resident and customer experience • Journey and process mapping • Stakeholder research • Policy and fee analysis • FOIL/public-records research • Grant strategy • Executive decision support

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Legislative Aide | Service Design & Strategic Operations

Mayor's Office, Village of Spring Valley | Spring Valley, NY | Dec 2025 – Present

- **311 problem reporting** | Overhauled the Village's 311 problem-reporting process: restructured intake and automated push notifications so public works staff receive new reports immediately. Previously only the department head was notified and had to relay each report to the DPW supervisor.
- **Website modernization** | Reorganized the EvoGov website's information architecture; redesigned the homepage and departmental pages; published a centralized Forms Index; and developed targeted HTML, CSS, and JavaScript improvements.
- **Facility requests** | Replaced in-person-only forms with online request workflows for seven public facilities and stage resources, covering approval, confirmation, cancellation, and calendar status changes; saves staff at least two business days. Scoped approval-before-payment as a future integration.
- **Taxi regulation** | Researched operating practices and drafted revisions to the Village's taxi and vehicle-for-hire code (Chapter 239): licensing, operator affiliation, fleet and dispatch accountability, trip records, and enforcement controls. The Village Board adopted the resulting local laws.
- **Fee modernization** | Reconciled the Village's historical fee schedules with departmental workload; developed revised fee tiers, applicant-funded escrow structures to cover outside professional review, and cost-recovery scenarios for leadership. Projected at least $86k annually across driver licensing, multifamily special permits, and taxi fleet licensing. The Village Board adopted all of the revised fees.
- **Flood-mitigation research** | Used FOIL requests, technical reports, and interagency correspondence to clarify Memorial Park project constraints; obtained NYS DEC study-eligibility guidance and helped secure County support documentation for grant planning.
- **State grant strategy** | Coordinated research, budgets, narratives, partner documents, and eligibility analysis for three 2026 NYS funding applications, including a $200K Empire State Development request for Memorial Park lighting ($471K total project) and an approximately $600K Climate Smart Communities request for extreme-weather response and public-works equipment; translated technical and program constraints into executive decision briefs.

Freelance UX & Design Researcher

Lonely Planet, Silver Fountain, Andovi+ and other clients | Remote | Feb 2022 – Dec 2025

- Led exploratory and qualitative research across travel, hospitality, and service experiences through interviews, contextual observation, and remote research sessions.
- Synthesized findings into personas, journey insights, mental models, and prioritized recommendations to guide product and development decisions.
- Connected behavioral patterns and usability friction to acquisition and engagement questions; maintained reusable research documentation for clients.

UX Researcher | First Dedicated Researcher

KOALA | Brooklyn, NY / Remote | Nov 2020 – Jul 2022

- Established KOALA's first dedicated UX research practice and insight repository, incorporating customer evidence into design and product prioritization.
- Conducted 90+ remote user interviews, along with usability studies and A/B tests, to identify listing-flow friction, content gaps, and conversion barriers.
- Research-informed improvements increased listing-flow task success from 33% to 46%; landing-page optimization was associated with a 36% reduction in bounce rate.
- Challenged low-value product assumptions and informed prioritization during a period of 23% user-base growth.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

SUNY Empire State University | B.A., Psychology; Business Administration

SUNY Rockland Community College | A.S., Business Marketing

General Assembly | UX Design & Research Certification

TOOLS & METHODS

Tools: Figma • Sketch • Miro • Qualtrics • Jira • Excel • HTML/CSS

Methods: Interviews • Contextual inquiry • Usability and A/B testing • Survey design • Thematic synthesis • Journey and process mapping